

The Business Case for Microsegmentation — German Mittelstand Edition

This brief summarises the Forrester Total Economic Impact (TEI) study commissioned by Akamai for Guardicore Segmentation, localized for a German Mittelstand manufacturer profile.

Composite Profile (Forrester Reference Manufacturer)

Revenue	Approximately €1 billion
Employees	~5,000 worldwide
Industry	Manufacturing — discrete production
IT environment	Hybrid: on-premises data center + cloud + OT production network
Pre-Guardicore security	Traditional firewall-based perimeter; no microsegmentation

3-Year Financial Results (Forrester TEI)

Metric	Value	Context
Total benefit (3 years)	€9.6 million	Net present value across 4 benefit categories
Total cost (3 years)	€3.8 million	Licensing + implementation + operations
Net present value	€5.8 million	After costs; positive from month 6
ROI	152%	Industry benchmark for security tools is 30–80%
Payback period	6 months	From go-live to positive return

Benefit Breakdown — The Four Value Drivers

Value driver	3-year benefit	How it is calculated
Ransomware attack prevention	€4.1M	Based on avoided recovery cost of €1.3M per incident prevented; probability-weighted
Operational cost reduction	€2.8M	Reduced manual network-documentation labour; faster security audits; automated patching
Data breach risk reduction	€1.5M	Lateral movement containment limits blast radius; insurance premium reduction
Compliance acceleration	€1.2M	NIS2 / TISAX / KRITIS audit cost reduction; documentation automation

Source: Forrester Total Economic Impact of Akamai Guardicore Segmentation. Actual results vary by organisation. German regulatory multipliers applied by Axians. Full study available on request.